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Current affairs February 2026

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Prime Minister Narendra Modi arrived in Israel on February 25, 2026 for a two-day visit. Modi delivered a historic speech in the Israeli Parliament (Knesset). This is the first time that an Indian Prime Minister has addressed the Israeli Parliament. The Knesset has honored him with its highest award, the 'Speaker of the Knesset Medal'. The parliament said that the award was presented to Modi in recognition of his efforts in strengthening strategic ties between India and Israel. Modi is the first leader to receive this medal. It was presented by Knesset Speaker Amir Ohana.

India exported smartphones worth \$30 billion (about Rs.2.7 lakh crore) in 2025, Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnav said on February 25, 2026. He said that smartphones were also the largest export from our country last year. In 2025, mobile phones worth Rs.5.5 lakh crore (60 billion dollars) were produced in our country.

The UK government has made it mandatory for tourists to have an electronic visa (e-visa). This rule has been implemented from February 25, 2026. This also applies to Indians. Those who do not require a visa must obtain an Electronic Travel Authorization (ETA).

Researchers from IIT Kanpur have created the world's first data-driven 3D model to observe the processes taking place in the heliosphere. This model will be very crucial for the study of astroclimatology. The sun is constantly undergoing processes like solar storms. These processes occur in a continuous cycle, sometimes severe, sometimes mild.

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Olivia Gadecki and John Peers won the Australian Open mixed doubles title. The Australian pair defeated Christina and Guinard (France) 4-6, 6-3, 10-8 in the final held in Melbourne on 30 January 2026. This is the second consecutive Australian Open mixed title for Olivia and Peers. This is the first time in 37 years that a pair has retained the title. Pugh and Navotna won the Australian Open mixed title twice in a row in 1988 and 1989.

The Central Economic Survey has revealed that the number of students from various countries coming to the country has increased in Andhra Pradesh, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat. The Central Government released the Economic Survey-2025-26 on January 29, 2026. While admissions have decreased in Karnataka and Tamil Nadu, which were previously the main centers for attracting foreign students, the enrollment of foreign students has increased in AP in the south. While the number of foreign students coming to the country was less than 7 thousand in 2000-01, it has reached about 49 thousand by 2020. However, this is only 0.10 percent of the total students enrolled in higher education.

WORLD BANK TO GIVE LOANS

India has agreed to provide \$8-10 billion (5,72,800-91,000) annually to the World Bank Group over the next five years. The new Country Partnership Framework (CPF) has been announced by the World Bank Group and India. These loans will help accelerate the next phase of growth, in line with our country's goal of becoming a developed economy.

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman presented the Budget for the year 2026-27 in the Lok Sabha on February 1, 2026. She presented the ninth consecutive Budget for the second time. This is the first time since

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independence that the Budget has been presented on a Sunday. The total budget is Rs.53,47,315 crore. Revenue collection: Rs.35,33,150 crore; Revenue expenditure: Rs.41,25,494 crore; Capital collection: Rs.18,14,165 crore; Capital expenditure: Rs.12,21,821 crore.

Carlos Alcaraz of Spain won the Australian Open. On February 1, 2026 | In the men's singles final in Melbourne, Alcaraz defeated ten-time champion Novak Djokovic (Serbia) 2-6, 6-2, 6-3, 7-5. Alcaraz hit 9 aces and 1 winner in the match. He hit 36 winners.

This is the first time former world number one Djokovic has lost in an Australian Open final. He has won all ten of his previous finals.

The government, which is conducting a special Non-Communicable Diseases (NCD) 4.0 survey to identify cancer cases across Andhra Pradesh, has created a Cancer Atlas for the first time in the country. The state government, which has declared cancer as a notifiable disease, is trying to improve the situation through the newly created atlas. According to the statistics mentioned in the Cancer Atlas, the highest number of cases are in Kakinada district (8101).

The Dalai Lama, 90, has won a Grammy Award for his sermon album, 'Meditations: The Reflections of His Holiness the Dalai Lama.' This is the first time the Tibetan spiritual leader has won a Golden Gramophone. The awards were announced in 90 categories at a ceremony held at the Crypto.com Arena in Los Angeles on February 2, 2026.

BJP leader Yumnam Khemchand Singh (62) was sworn in as the new Chief Minister of Manipur on February 4, 2026. Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla administered the oath to him. Manipur has been wracked by communal clashes since May 3, 2023. Nearly 260 people have died in these clashes. In

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the wake of the subsequent developments, the then CM Biren Singh resigned on February 9, 2025. Manipur has been under President's rule since February 13.

◆ Recently, the MLAs of the state's NDA partner parties met in Delhi on February 3, 2026 and elected Khemchand as their legislative party leader. In this context, President Draupadi Murmu issued orders lifting President's rule in Manipur.

Hyderabadi shooter Isha Singh won gold at the Asian Shooting Championships. Isha, who won the gold medal in the women's 10m air pistol event in the tournament that began in Delhi on February 4, 2026, also won gold in the team event. Isha (239.8) topped the individual final. Chinese Taipei girls Cheng Yen Cheng (235.4) and Yi Ai Wen (217.7) won silver and bronze medals respectively.

Royal Challengers Bangalore (RCB) emerged as the winners of the Women's Premier League (WPL) 2026. The RCB team defeated Delhi Capitals in the final held at the Kotambi Stadium in Vadodara on February 5, 2026.

Delhi Capitals scored 203 runs for 4 wickets in 20 overs, while RCB scored 204 runs for 4 wickets in 19.4 overs. 204 runs is the highest total in WPL. The previous record was also held by RCB (202 against Gujarat).

For the first time in the country, the cooperative sector cab services platform 'Bharat Taxi' was launched by Union Cooperation Minister Amit Shah on February 5, 2026. Initially, these services will be available in Delhi-NCR and Gujarat.

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Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

In its sixth and final bi-monthly monetary policy review for the current financial year (2025-26), the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has kept its key rates unchanged. It has made key announcements such as compensation for those affected by digital frauds; increase in unsecured loan amount for micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs). Despite increased international uncertainties, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said that the trade agreement signed with the US and Europe will provide a positive environment for the economy.

Indrazal Drone Defense has signed a major agreement with Sigma Advanced Systems (Megasoft) to manufacture fully indigenous anti-drone systems. Under this, Sigma will specifically design and supply electronic equipment such as radar, sensor scanning, jamming, and spoofing, which are key components of Indrazal's counter-drone system.

IIT-Madras Professor Balaraman Ravindran has been selected to be part of the United Nations' new independent scientific committee on artificial intelligence, comprising 40 international experts. The experts on this list were personally recommended by UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres. The committee will last for three years.

India successfully test-fired the nuclear-capable Agni-3 ballistic missile on February 6, 2026. The launch took place from Chandipur off the Odisha coast. The weapon, which can engage surface-to-surface targets, has a range of over 3,000 km, officials said.

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The advanced missile, Agni-3, has already entered the Indian Army's arsenal. It can carry a payload of 1.5 tonnes. It is 17 metres long and has two solid-fuelled stages.

Uday Nagaraju from Telangana was sworn in as a life peer on February 11, 2026, in the century-old upper house of the British Parliament, the House of Lords. He took the oath on the Bhagavad Gita, wearing a dark red gown, in a ceremony held in accordance with British traditions. Uday Nagaraju, a native of Shanigaram village in Koheda mandal of Siddipet district, moved to Britain about 25 years ago. As the founder of the Mahatma Gandhi Future Leaders Program, he is working to instill moral leadership, social justice, and Gandhian values among the youth.

Mumbai coastal highways authorities have created a record by launching India's first musical road. With the help of Hungarian technology, several musical strips have been installed on the road from Nariman area towards Worli. With this, motorists will be able to hear the song 'Jaya Ho' from the movie 'Slumdog Millionaire' for about 500 meters on this road. When vehicles travel at a speed of 70-80 kmph, the friction of the special strips on the road produces sound waves saying 'Jaya Ho'.

The government has appointed Dr. Jyoti Buddhaprakash as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Singareni Collieries Company Limited. D. Krishnabhaskar, who was holding full additional responsibilities in that post, has been relieved. Buddhaprakash is currently the Secretary, SC Development Department. Telangana State Government Chief Secretary K. Ramakrishna Rao issued orders appointing him as CMD on February 11, 2026.

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Chemical Engineering students of Gyanmanjari Innovative University, Bhavnagar, Gujarat have designed an underwater drone. It can be used for national defense needs and in industries. The students displayed it at a science exhibition organized at the university. It was revealed that it was designed keeping the chemical industries in mind.

The 'India AI Impact Expo-2026, Summit', hosted by India to discuss in detail the field of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and create awareness about cutting-edge innovations, began in Delhi on February 16, 2026. The expo summits, which will be held at Bharat Mandapam, Sushma Swaraj Bhavan and Ambedkar Centre till February 20, were inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The theme of this summit is: Sarva Jan Hitaya.. Sarva Jana Sukhya (Welfare of all).

A recent report by SBI Research has revealed that the amount of cash in circulation in the country has reached a lifetime high of Rs 40 lakh crore by the end of January 2026. However, in a span of five years, the cash ratio has declined from 14.4% to 11% as a percentage of GDP.

The Union Ministry of Power has announced that 50,000 MW of additional power generation capacity has been made available across the country in the first ten months of the financial year 2025-26. It has been revealed that from April 1, 2025 to January 31, 2026, a net increase of 52,537 MW of power capacity has been added across all generation channels across the country. Of this, 39,657 MW is from renewable energy. Of this, 34,955 MW is from solar and 4,613 MW is from wind power.

India is among the six countries that account for 61 percent of agricultural greenhouse gas emissions, a new study has found. The list also includes

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China, Indonesia, the US, Thailand and Brazil. The research was conducted by scientists from the College of Agriculture and Life Sciences at Cornell University in the US. They have provided a detailed map of agricultural emissions by crop and source.

A modern device for accurate prediction of cyclones, the Wave Propelled Vertical Profiler (WVP), has been developed by the National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT), Chennai. NIOT claims that it has developed the first wave-powered 'WVP' in the country to obtain data related to ocean monitoring and coastal operations. It has been successfully tested at a depth of 50 meters off the Chennai coast.

Japanese Prime Minister Sane Takaichi took office for a second term on February 18, 2026, after winning a landslide victory in the parliamentary elections. In the recently released results of the lower house of parliament elections, the Liberal Democratic Party led by Takaichi won a two-thirds majority.

The India Impact Summit was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 19 February 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in Delhi. On this occasion, he unveiled the 'MANAV' vision for the proper use of AI. M: Moral and Ethical Systems; A: Accountable Governance; N: National Sovereignty; A: Accessible, Inclusive; V: Valid, Legitimate.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh inaugurated 'MILAN 2026' on February 19, 2026 at the Samudrika Auditorium at the Eastern Naval Headquarters in Visakhapatnam. The Minister said that MILAN will seek to enhance mutual capabilities and further foster a friendly atmosphere between the navies of the participating countries.

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In an effort to protect critical financial data and strengthen the continuity of key systems, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has built a high-security data center in Odisha. It has been built in a strategic location, remote from attacks and not prone to earthquakes. It is reported that a Tier 4 certification design has been used for this.

With the aim of further strengthening India's relations with foreign parliamentarians through dialogues, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on February 23, 2026, constituted Parliamentary Friendship Groups. Each group will have 11 members. These have been formed to strengthen relations with a total of 64 countries.

Varkala Vijayalakshmi, a handloom woman from Koyyalagudeni, Choutuppal mandal, Yadadri Bhuvanagiri district, Telangana, has been awarded the highest talent award. She received it from Union Textile Minister Giriraj Singh in Delhi on February 23, 2026.

The statue of Chakravarthy Rajagopalachari, the first and only Indian Governor General of independent India, was unveiled by Draupadi Murmu at the Rashtrapati Bhavan in Delhi on 23 February 2026. The statue, by British architect Edwin Lutyens, was removed from the Grand Open Staircase near the Ashoka Mandapam and replaced with this one.

Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu has announced that a Hexagonal Alliance will soon be formed with India, West Asia and its surrounding countries. He announced that it will include India, Arab, African and Asian countries, as well as Mediterranean countries (Greece and Cyprus).

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Former judge José María Balcázar (83) was elected president of Peru on February 19, 2026. He is the 8th president in 10 years. The election took place the day after interim president José Jeri was removed from office due to corruption allegations. Balcázar, who ran for the left-wing Peru Libre party, defeated three other candidates in the 130-member legislature. Peru will hold general elections on April 12, 2026.

India and Brazil have decided to take annual bilateral trade to \$30 billion over the next five years. To this end, talks were held between Prime Minister Modi and Brazilian President Lula da Silva on 21 February 2026. As part of this, the two countries signed an agreement to cooperate in the key minerals sector. Lula arrived in India on 18 February to participate in the AI Summit and hold talks with Modi.

The Commerce Ministry said that domestic pharma exports grew by 9.4% to Rs 5.2.7 lakh crore in the financial year 2024-25. The industry is targeting double-digit growth by 2026-27. India, the third largest producer in the world, exports medicines to over 200 countries.

A key decision was taken at the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS) meeting to form joint working groups on maritime security, information exchange, disaster relief and cooperation. The ninth IONS meeting was held on February 20, 2026, as part of the world-class events organized in Visakhapatnam under the name of ISR, MILAN and Symposium.

Current Affairs

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The National Commission for Women (NCW) organised 'Shakti Samvaad', an interactive and capacity-building meeting with State Women's Commissions (SWCs) at the Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on 29 January 2026. All State Women's Commissions across the country were participated in this meeting.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the European Securities and Markets Authority (ESMA) during the recent visit of the President of the European Council and the President of the European Commission to India. The Ministry of Finance stated that the primary objective of the MoU is to enable formal recognition of the Clearing Corporation of India Limited (CCIL) and other RBI-regulated Central Counterparties (CCPs) by ESMA. The MoU is effective from the date of signing by the Authorities and will remain operative for an unlimited period.

The Indian Navy and the Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF) discussed ways to enhance maritime cooperation and inter-operability, while promoting a collaborative approach towards a free and open Indo-Pacific, at the 11th edition of the Staff Talks in New Delhi on 30 January 2026. The talks were co-chaired by Assistant Chief of Naval Staff (Foreign Cooperation and Intelligence) Rear Admiral Srinivas Maddula and JMSDF Director General (Operations and Plans) Rear Admiral Toshiyuki Hirata.

Sunetra Pawar, took the oath of office as deputy chief minister of Maharashtra on 31 January 2026. She became the first woman to hold this position in the history of the state. She succeeds her husband Ajit Pawar who died in a plane crash on January 28. The swearing-in ceremony, held at Lok Bhavan, was administered by the Governor and attended by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis of the BJP and Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde of the Shiv Sena.

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Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia took charge as the new Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C) of the Indian Air Force's Eastern Air Command on 1 February 2026. An alumnus of the National Defence Academy, Walia was commissioned into the fighter stream of the IAF on June 11, 1988. He is qualified to fly multiple frontline fighter aircraft, including the MiG-21, MiG-23, MiG-27, Jaguar, and Su-30 MKI, and has logged over 3,200 hours of accident-free flying during his distinguished career spanning more than three decades.

The Patna Bird Sanctuary in Etah, Uttar Pradesh, and Chhari-Dhand in Kutch, Gujarat, have been officially designated as Ramsar wetlands, bringing India's total number of recognized wetlands to 98. This development reinforces India's commitment to protecting wetlands and biodiversity under global frameworks. Ramsar sites are recognized for their international ecological importance, serving as critical habitats for waterfowl and vital biodiversity hotspots.

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully demonstrated the Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR) technology from the Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, off the coast of Odisha on 3 February 2026. This marks a significant milestone in India's missile development programme and places the country among a select group of nations possessing this advanced propulsion technology.

Indian-origin climate scientist Veerabhadran Ramanathan has been awarded the 2026 Crafoord Prize in Geosciences by the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences. Often described as the "Nobel of Geosciences," the prize recognises Ramanathan's decades of research on super-pollutants and atmospheric brown clouds, which have reshaped understanding of global warming.

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India and Tanzania held the fourth meeting of the Joint Defence Cooperation Committee (JDCC) in Zanzibar on 3 February 2026. During the meeting, both sides discussed a wide range of areas for collaboration, including military training, service-to-service engagement, maritime security and defence industry cooperation. The discussions reflected the shared interest of the two countries in enhancing defence preparedness and regional security.

The 13th edition of the joint military Exercise KHANJAR between India and Kyrgyzstan began at Misamari in Sonitpur district of Assam on 3 February 2026. This aims to enhance interoperability between the Special Forces of both nations, with a focus on joint operations in urban warfare and counter-terrorism scenarios under the United Nations mandate. The 14-day-long military exercise concludes on 17 February. India and Kyrgyzstan organising joint military exercises annually since 2011, with venues alternating between the countries to reflect deepening defence ties.

India have clinched the U19 Cricket World Cup 2026 title for a record sixth time in Harare, Zimbabwe on 6 February 2026. India defeated England by 100 runs in the final. India scored a massive total of 411 for nine in the stipulated 50 overs. England were bowled out for 311 in 40.2 overs.

India has signed Memorandum of Understanding (MoUs) and agreements with 23 countries to share and cooperate on its Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), reinforcing the country's growing role as a global leader in digital governance and fintech innovation. The agreements aim to facilitate the replication and adoption of India's digital platforms under the India Stack framework, said Union Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology Jitin Prasada in a written reply to Rajya Sabha on 6 February 2026.

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Indian teacher Rouble Nagi received the Global Teacher Prize 2026 during the World Government Summit on 5 February 2026, winning the one million dollar award presented by GEMS Education in its tenth edition. Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, presented the Global Teacher Prize 2026 to Rouble Nagi.

India and the Netherlands on 6 February 2026 took a step toward strengthening bilateral cooperation in clean energy research with the launch of the India-Netherlands Hydrogen Fellowship Programme and the signing of a key academic partnership between the University of Groningen and 19 Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs). The initiatives, facilitated by the Department of Science and Technology (DST), aim to boost research capacity, talent development, and deployment-oriented innovation in green hydrogen technologies, a critical pillar of India's clean energy transition.

Andhra Pradesh Finance Minister Payyavula Keshav presented the State Budget for the 2026-27 financial year in the Assembly on 14 February 2026.

The Budget specified a total outlay of Rs.3,32,205 crore. Of this, revenue expenditure is estimated at Rs.2,56,142 crore, while capital expenditure stands at Rs.53,915 crore. The revenue deficit is estimated at Rs.22,002 crore and the fiscal deficit at Rs. 75,868 crore.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated a series of major infrastructure projects in Assam on 14 February 2026, including the Kumar Bhaskar Varma Setu over the Brahmaputra River in Guwahati and the North-East's first Emergency Landing Facility (ELF) on a national highway in Dibrugarh district.

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India's Pramod Bhagat captured the men's SL3 gold medal at the BWF Para World Championships on 14 February 2026. He defeated Muhammad Al Imran of Indonesia with 21-12, 21-18 in the final. This is his fourth consecutive singles gold at the world championships and his sixth overall world title in the category.

The government on 14 February 2026, gave its go ahead to PM RAHAT (Road Accident Victim Hospitalization and Assured Treatment) Scheme aimed at ensuring immediate medical assistance to road accident vic-tims to prevent fatalities.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi held bilat-eral talks with French President Emmanuel Macron at Maharashtra Lok Bhavan in Mumbai on 17 February 2026. India and France agreed to upgrade the India-France relationship to a Special Global Strategic Partnership. There were a total of 21 out-comes. Both nations agreed to the launch of the India-France Year of Innovation and the India-France Innovation Network.

Modi and Macron virtually inaugurated the Final Assembly Line (FAL) for H125 helicopters in Vemagal Industrial Area in Kolar (near Bengaluru), Karnataka.

Bangladesh Nationalist Party leader Tarique Rahman was sworn in as Bangladesh's Prime Minister on 17 February 2026. He is the son of former Prime Minister Khaleda Zia and assas-sinated President Ziaur Rahman. President Mohammed Shahabuddin officiated Rahman and his cabinet took their oaths.

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Telangana Chief Minister A.Revanth Reddy inaugurated the 23rd edition of BioAsia 2026 international summit on 17 February 2026. The two-day global conference will be held at the Hyderabad International Convention Centre (HICC). This year's summit is themed TechBio Unleashed AI, Automation, and the Revolutionary Changes in Life Sciences.'

The Indian Army is hosting the inaugural United Nations Fellowship Training Programme on Small Arms and Light Weapons (SALW) Control for the first time in Asia for the Asia-Pacific region. The program is being held under the aegis of the Ministry of External Affairs and the Ministry of Defence from February 16 to March 6, 2026.

Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan released and launched the book, The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism: The Life, Lessons and Legacy of Sree Narayana Guru, in New Delhi. The book is authored by Member of Parliament, Dr. Shashi Tharoor. The Vice-President said that Sree Narayana Guru emerged as a spiritual guide at a time when caste divisions and social discrimination were deeply entrenched in society.

The DRDO has conducted a successful qualification-level load test of the Drogue Parachute for the Gaganyaan programme in Chandigarh. The Ministry of Defence said that the dynamic test, simulating qualification-level loads which are higher than the maximum flight loads, shows the additional design safety margin of the parachute. The test was conducted with the ISRO, Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment, and DRDO, alongside various TBRL's dedicated teams.

India assumed the chairmanship of the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS) from Thailand during the 9th Conclave of Chiefs held in

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Visakhapatnam on 20 February 2026, marking its return to the leadership of the forum after 16 years. India will hold the chair for the next two years. Having earlier held the inaugural Chairmanship from 2008 to 2010.

India and the United States have signed the Pax Silica declaration at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi on 20 February 2026. This declaration will strengthen collaboration in areas like the production of critical minerals and semiconductors and in the rapidly evolving Artificial Intelligence space, to create a safe and strong global silicon and technology ecosystem.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagged off the Meerut Metro and Namoo Bharat Train at Shatabdi Nagar Namoo Bharat Station in Meerut, Uttar Pradesh on 22 February 2026. He dedicated to the Nation entire 82 Km Delhi-Meerut Namoo Bharat Corridor and inaugurated the remaining sections of India's first Namoo Bharat Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS).

India women's cricket team captain Harmanpreet Kaur created history after she became the most-capped international player in women's cricket. She made her 356th appearance for India in Twenty20 match against Australia on 20 February 2026, surpassing New Zealand great Suzie Bates. Australia's Ellyse Perry is third in the list with 349 international matches to her name.

The National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (NOTTO) has recorded unprecedented progress in organ donation, allocation, and transplantation across the country. The number of transplants in the country has increased from fewer than 5,000 in 2013 to nearly 20,000 in 2025, marking a remarkable fourfold rise.

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The Commerce Ministry said the base year of India's merchandise trade Indices has been revised from 2012-13 to 2022-23 to reflect structural changes in the economy, shifts in commodity composition, evolving trade patterns and better alignment with current macroeconomic indicators.

Senior bureaucrat Nidhi Chibber was given additional charge of Niti Aayog's Chief Executive Officer (CEO) on 24 February 2026. She is the 1994 batch Indian Administrative Service officer of the Chhattisgarh cadre. Incumbent CEO BVR Subrahmanyam completed his tenure on February 24.

The Troops of the Indian Army's Southern Command conducted Exercise Agni Varsha at the Pokhran Field Firing Range in Rajasthan on 24 February 2026. The exercise focused on coordinated employment of combined arms, precision long-range fires and network-enabled command and control in a realistic battlefield setting.

The Union Cabinet approved a proposal to alter the name of the State of Kerala to "Keralam" on 24 February 2026. The decision was taken at a meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Following the Cabinet's approval, the President of India will refer the proposed legislation the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026 to the Kerala Legislative Assembly for its views, as mandated under Article 3 of the Constitution.

Ministry of Home Affairs unveiled the country's new national counter-terrorism policy and strategy titled PRAHAAR on 23 February 2026. The strategy outlines a comprehensive framework to address evolving terror threats using a proactive approach to prevent and counter terrorist threats.